



USER GUIDE · PART 05

Invoicing & Reports

Bill your customers, get paid, and see how the business is doing

Invoicing & Reports

This is where you bill your customers, track who's paid and who still owes, and get a plain-English snapshot of how the business is doing. You create and send invoices, record payments as they come in, and the Reports page rolls it all up automatically.

Invoices

The **Invoices** page lists every invoice in one table — name, client, total, amount paid, remaining balance, status, and last touched. Click a row to open it; the ✕ deletes one (with a confirm).

Three ways to create an invoice

- 1 **From scratch** — click **+ New Invoice** for a blank invoice and the editor.
- 2 **From an estimate** — convert an estimate; Fieldscale copies the client, line items (with your markup and profit already baked in exactly as quoted), discount, notes, terms, and the right tax, so you bill exactly what was approved.
- 3 **From a job draw (progress billing)** — bill a single "draw" (a percentage of the contract), e.g. "Progress draw — Rough-in (30% of contract)." That draw is marked billed so you can't bill it twice, and approved change orders are folded into the contract first.

The invoice editor

Your **Company** block auto-fills from your Company Profile (name, phone, email, license, address, logo). The **Bill To** block holds the client's name, email, address, project, invoice number, date, and due date.

Line items — each has a description, code, quantity, a unit (SF, LF, EA, CY, HR, LS), a unit price, and an auto-calculated amount. Add them **from the price book** (fills in name, unit, and a price built from material + labor + waste) or as a **blank line**.

Invoice numbering

Numbers count up automatically from a company-wide counter you set on the Company page (e.g. INV-1001, INV-1002...), keeping any prefix and zero-padding. If you haven't set a counter and you type a number by hand, Fieldscale learns it and continues from there. You can always override the number on any invoice.

Taxes and totals (all calculated live)

Subtotal

Sum of all line amounts.

Discount

A percent or a flat dollar amount, taken off before tax (never more than the subtotal).

Tax

A percentage on the discounted subtotal (or a fixed carried-over amount from an estimate, e.g. materials-only tax).

Late fee

A flat dollar amount you can add for overdue payment.

Deposit due

A percent or flat amount shown as "deposit due upfront" — informational; it doesn't change the balance.

Amount paid / Balance due

Balance = total – amount paid, and turns green when paid off.

Statuses and recording payments

Status is calculated automatically from what's been paid — there are exactly three: **unpaid** (red), **partial** (orange), and **paid** (green). To record money in, open the invoice, type the running total received into **Amount paid**, and **Save**. The balance and status update instantly.

Two things that surprise new users

There's no "mark as sent/paid" button — status comes purely from Amount paid. And "Amount paid" is the **cumulative** total received, not one payment at a time (there's no separate payment log).

Sending an invoice

Generate PDF

A clean, printable invoice with your logo, totals, notes, terms, and a Pay Now button if you added a link. Use your browser's "Save as PDF / Print."

Email invoice

Opens your own email app with the customer's address and a ready-written message including the total, balance, and Pay Now link. You send it from your normal email — nothing to set up.

Pay Now (online payment)

Paste your own payment link (Stripe, PayPal.Me, Venmo, Square...) and a green Pay Now button appears on the invoice, PDF, and portal. Fieldscale doesn't process payments — you just supply the link.

Other invoice tools

Duplicate

A fresh unpaid copy with the next number — handy for repeat jobs.

Recurring

Repeat every N months (e.g. a retainer); when due it appears on Follow-ups for one-click generation.

Lien Release / waiver

A printable lien waiver tied to the invoice — conditional or unconditional, progress or final.

Notes & payment terms

Free-text blocks that print on the invoice.

The customer portal

A public, no-login page a customer opens via a private link you share. On it they can see the **project status** and progress bar, view and **approve estimates**, view their **invoices** (with a green Pay button when there's a balance and a Pay Now link), and act on **change orders**.

Change orders

Change orders live on a **job** but flow through the portal and Reports. Each has a title, scope, a "why," itemized lines, and a price change. In the portal the customer sees a plain card — e.g. "This change adds \$1,200 — new project total \$46,200" — and can **Approve** (by typing their name) or **Decline**. Once approved, the price folds into the job's contract everywhere; you tick **Billed** after you invoice it.

Reports

A single scrolling snapshot built automatically from your estimates, jobs, and invoices. (Accounts set to "hide financials" can't open it.) It's a live current-state view — there are no manual date pickers; the only time windows are the ones it computes for you.

Owner dashboard

Invoiced, Collected, Outstanding, Active jobs, Win rate, a 6-month invoiced-vs-collected chart, and a jobs-by-status breakdown.

Production

Active/completed jobs, hours logged, behind-schedule list, and an Export time (CSV) for payroll.

Work in progress (WIP)

Active contract, earned to date, billed to date, and over/(under)-billed per job — so you spot money earned but not yet invoiced.

Unbilled change orders

Approved changes you haven't invoiced yet, so none slip through.

Accounts receivable

Outstanding money with an aging breakdown (Current, 1–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+ days) and a QuickBooks/Xero CSV export.

Job profitability

Contract vs. cost vs. profit vs. margin per job.

Estimate win-rate

Win rate %, value won, and accepted/rejected/open counts.

Cash-flow forecast

Expected money in from unpaid invoices, bucketed by when it's due.

Lead sources

Which sources actually turn into won work.

The typical workflow

- 1 **Win the work** — build an estimate; mark it Accepted (or the customer approves it in the portal).
- 2 **Turn it into an invoice** — convert the estimate (client, lines, discount, tax carry over) or, for bigger jobs, bill each **draw** as you hit milestones.
- 3 **Add a way to pay** — paste your Stripe/PayPal/Venmo link, set the due date and any deposit, review totals.
- 4 **Send it** — Email invoice (from your own email) or Generate PDF. Share the portal link if you like.
- 5 **Get paid** — when money comes in, update Amount paid and Save; status flips to partial or paid.
- 6 **Handle scope changes** — add a change order on the job; the customer approves in the portal; tick Billed after invoicing.
- 7 **Track it in Reports** — watch invoiced vs. collected, chase overdue balances in A/R, and check WIP and profitability.

Tips & gotchas

- **Set up your invoice counter first** on the Company page (with any prefix like "INV-"). Skip it and your first hand-typed number becomes the seed.
- **Fill out your Company Profile and logo** before sending — the invoice, PDF, portal, and statements all pull from it.
- **Emailing an invoice doesn't change its status or record anything** — it just opens your email app with a draft.

- **Pay Now needs your own link** (a full https:// URL) — no link, no Pay button.
- **Overdue is driven by the due date.** No due date means an invoice never ages into the past-due buckets.
- **Feed the reports** — win-rate needs estimates marked Accepted/Rejected; lead-source needs a source on each lead; the unbilled-CO report needs you to tick "Billed."
- **Lien waivers are generic templates** — several states require exact wording, so have yours reviewed.